

CSS Units - Quick Reference

CSS units control sizing, spacing, and layout on webpages. They are divided into: Absolute Units (fixed size) and Relative Units (responsive and scalable).

Type	Unit	Best Used For	Scales With
Relative	rem	Typography, spacing, layout	Root <html> font size
Relative	em	Component spacing	Current/parent font size
Relative	%	Flexible layouts	Parent element size
Relative	vw / vh	Hero sections, full-screen layouts	Viewport width/height
Absolute	px	Borders, icons, fixed details	Screen pixels (fixed)

Relative Units (Recommended)

Relative units are the foundation of responsive web design because they adapt across phones, tablets, and desktops.

Font-Relative Units

rem: Based on the root font size. Example: If root font size is 16px, then 1.5rem = 24px.

em: Based on the current element or parent font size. If font-size is 20px, then 2em = 40px.

ch: Width of the '0' character. Useful for readable text widths.

Viewport Units

vw: 1% of viewport width.

vh: 1% of viewport height.

vmin: 1% of the smaller viewport dimension.

vmax: 1% of the larger viewport dimension.

Container & Layout Units

?: Relative to the parent element.

fr: CSS Grid unit that distributes remaining free space.